

THOMAS BROADSIDE CO.

THE WESTERN CANON

Words to live with.

Make room for the enduring.



A CONTEMPORARY VISUAL MEDITATION

AN INVITATION TO ATTEND

Read slowly. Return often.

A homecoming. A blessing. A question about the soul. A prayer for rest. A path through the dark.

Poetry, scripture, prayer and art speak in different ways. This room gives each work its name, its translation, and its source. The invitation is to read, to consider, and to return.

The landscapes and reading room are contemporary visual meditations. The broadsides shown are the actual designs in our collection.

01 / HOMECOMING

A long way home.



Tell me, O Muse, of that ingenious hero
who travelled far and wide after he had
sacked the famous town of Troy.

Homer · The Odyssey, Book I · trans. Samuel Butler

[READ THE SOURCE](#)

[EXAMINE THE SHEET](#)

02 / MERCY

Words to receive with care.



Blessed are the merciful: for they shall
obtain mercy.

Jesus of Nazareth · Matthew 5:7 · Authorized Version

READ THE SOURCE

EXAMINE THE SHEET

03 / THE SOUL

The question remains.



For what is a man profited, if he shall gain the whole world, and lose his own soul? or what shall a man give in exchange for his soul?

Jesus of Nazareth · Matthew 16:26 · Authorized Version

READ THE SOURCE

EXAMINE THE SHEET

04 / REST

A prayer on the page.



Thou madest us for Thyself, and our
heart is restless, until it repose in Thee.

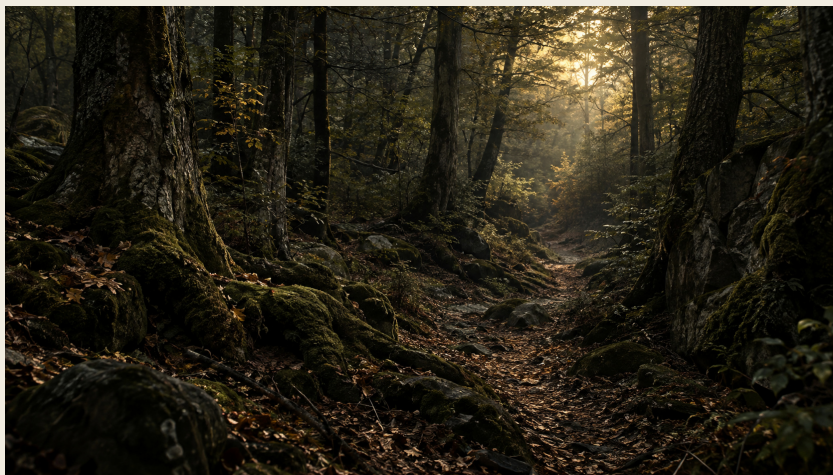
Augustine • Confessions, Book I • trans. E. B. Pusey

READ THE SOURCE

EXAMINE THE SHEET

05 / THE WAY

At the edge of the wood.



Midway upon the journey of our life
I found myself within a forest dark,
For the straightforward pathway had
been lost.

Dante · Inferno, Canto I, lines 1–3 · trans. H. W. Longfellow

READ THE SOURCE

EXAMINE THE SHEET

THE CONVERSATION IN IMAGES

Christ Preaching



Christ Preaching

Rembrandt - The Hundred Guilder Print, c. 1649

AUSTIN, TX - PRINTED BY THE THOMAS BROADSIDE CO. - 090002

Rembrandt van Rijn / c. 1649

National Gallery of Art / Object 9969

An etching of Christ and the gathered people. The Hundred Guilder Print brings the ministry into a field of light, line and deep shadow.

[VIEW THE MUSEUM RECORD](#)

THE CONVERSATION IN IMAGES

Aristotle with a Bust of Homer



Aristotle with a Bust of Homer
Rembrandt 1653

ARTIST, 1653. PRINTED BY THE THOMAS BROADSIDE CO., BOSTON.

Rembrandt van Rijn / 1653

The Metropolitan Museum of Art / Object 437394

A philosopher rests his hand on the poet's bust. Rembrandt brings poetry and philosophy into the same quiet encounter.

[VIEW THE MUSEUM RECORD](#)

THE CONVERSATION IN IMAGES

The Circle of the Lustful



The Circle of the Lustful

William Blake - Inferno, Canto V - 1827

AUSTIN, TX - PRINTED BY THE THOMAS BROADSIDE CO. - 090002

William Blake / 1827

National Gallery of Art / Object 797

Paolo and Francesca, from Dante's *Inferno*, Canto V. Blake's engraving is a later artist's encounter with the poem.

[VIEW THE MUSEUM RECORD](#)

FROM THE PAGE TO YOUR PLACE

Give the words a home.

The Western Canon Set

Five texts: The Odyssey, The Beatitudes, What is a man profited?,
Our heart is restless, and Midway upon the journey.

The three art reproductions are available separately. Explore each product
page for its source, paper, size and available formats.



Explore the room and watch the film.
Printed in Austin, Texas.

thomasbroadside.co/canon

THE RECORD STAYS WITH THE WORK

Keep the source.

The Odyssey, Book I

Homer / translated by Samuel Butler, 1900

The Gospel according to St Matthew

Authorized Version (King James Version)

Confessions, Book I

Augustine / translated by E. B. Pusey

Inferno, Canto I, lines 1–3

Dante / translated by Henry Wadsworth Longfellow, 1867

Christ Preaching (The Hundred Guilder Print)

Rembrandt van Rijn / c. 1649 / National Gallery of Art

Aristotle with a Bust of Homer

Rembrandt van Rijn / 1653 / The Metropolitan Museum of Art

The Circle of the Lustful: Paolo and Francesca

William Blake / 1827 / National Gallery of Art

Source texts: public domain in the United States. Museum images: the open-access records linked above. Imagined landscapes and room: contemporary campaign artwork. Readings retain the translation named on each sheet.

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